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MAAJ TRADING

Madagascar Vanilla

2026 CATALOGUE

BOURBON PODS · ALCOHOL-FREE OLEORESINS



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01 · ORIGIN

The story of an exceptional vanilla

In Madagascar, vanilla is not manufactured. It is grown with patience, picked by hand, and processed through gestures passed down over generations.

Between the pollinated flower and a pod ready for use, twelve to eighteen months go by — time that cannot be shortened without losing aromatic richness.

That standard, that long span of time and that artisanal know-how are what Maaj Trading commits to bringing to you.



You never rush a vanilla. You wait until it is ready.

02 · THE COMPANY

Why Maaj Trading

We have chosen rigour over volume, and direct relationships over anonymous intermediation.

A producer-processor, not a reseller

From raw pod to oleoresin, everything is controlled on site, by the same team, with quality control built into every stage.

A standard that can be verified

Every reference comes with technical data sheets and certificates of analysis. We met and vetted our producing partner in person.

A range designed without compromise

Our entire range is alcohol-free and free of synthetic solvents: water and vanilla, nothing else.

A commitment beyond trade

Working with Maaj Trading means directly supporting the families who live from this production.



Behind every gram of vanilla we offer there is a face, a gesture, a whole season of patience. That is the story we want you to taste.

MAAWA SOUARE · FOUNDER

03

Our production process

From the pollinated flower to the bottle of extract, two distinct crafts follow one another at our producing partner: growing and curing the pod, then transforming it.

STAGE I ON THE PLANTATION

From vine to harvest

01

Pollination and growing

Every flower is pollinated by hand, one by one. Grown without pesticides or chemical fertiliser, the pods develop over about nine months.

02

The harvest

Too early, the pod has not developed its potential; too late, it loses quality. Picking happens just as the tip begins to turn yellow.

03

Curing

Scalding, sweating, then gradual drying, under strict control of moisture content (around 32%), brought down to 25-28% where needed.

04

Conditioning and grading

Conditioned, sorted and graded by hand (16 cm and up for the Gourmet), then packed in paraffined paper so the pod keeps breathing.

Nine months of growing, then several weeks of curing.

STAGE II IN THE WORKSHOP

From pod to extract

A process designed to preserve the aromatic integrity of the vanilla, without ever resorting to alcohol or synthetic solvents.

01

Soaking

The dried, conditioned pods are cut and left to soak: their aromatic compounds begin to release.

02

Water extraction

Where conventional methods use alcohol, our partner extracts the aromas with distilled water only.

03

Vacuum concentration

At low temperature, to protect the most fragile molecules. This stage sets the concentration: 10X, 20X.

04

Packing and control

Stored away from light and heat, with specific gravity and vanillin content checked batch after batch.

Full control of the process is what sets a producer-processor apart from a trader.

04 · TERROIR

Madagascar, home of Bourbon vanilla

Vanilla grows in Mexico, its historic cradle, in Uganda, Indonesia and French Polynesia. But Madagascar is where Bourbon vanilla, *Vanilla planifolia*, is grown — recognised as the world benchmark.

The name "Bourbon" comes from the former Île Bourbon, today Réunion, where hand pollination was devised in the 19th century before spreading to Madagascar.

Tropical climate, altitude and soils create rare conditions: a high vanillin content and a warm, chocolatey, woody profile.

N°1
PRODUCER WORLDWIDE

19th
CENTURY · HAND POLLINATION



05 · THE CHOICE

Why the whole range is alcohol-free

THE MARKET STANDARD

Alcohol extraction

Effective, but it rules out part of the professional market and their customers: religious requirements, dietary sensitivities, demands for purity.

THE COMMON ALTERNATIVE

Synthetic solvents

Some "alcohol-free" products swap ethanol for propylene glycol: the alcohol question is settled, a chemical ingredient is added.

OUR CHOICE

Water and vanilla, nothing else

Maceration and concentration in water. A longer, more demanding process, but a product whose every ingredient can be named.

No alcohol, no synthetic solvents.

06

Our range

01 Bourbon Gourmet pods

02 Alcohol-free oleoresin AF10X

03 Alcohol-free oleoresin AF20X





REFERENCE 01

Bourbon Gourmet pods

Black, supple, glossy, both generous and intense. Hand-selected and carefully graded.

ORIGIN	Madagascar
VARIETY	Vanilla planifolia (Bourbon)
GRADE	16 cm and up
VANILLIN CONTENT	Minimum 1.8%
MOISTURE	25-30%
AROMA PROFILE	Warm, chocolatey, woody, lightly caramelised
RECOMMENDED USES	Infusions, creams, preparations where the pod stays visible
SHELF LIFE	Minimum 2 years under good conditions

REFERENCE 02

Alcohol-free oleoresin AF10X

An ideal way into Malagasy vanilla, with no alcohol and no solvent.

ORIGIN	Madagascar
EXTRACTION METHOD	Distilled water + vacuum concentration
ALCOHOL	None
VANILLIN CONTENT	Minimum 1.2%
APPEARANCE	Dark brown liquid, lightly fluid
AROMA PROFILE	Round, sweet, classic vanilla notes
INDICATIVE DOSAGE	A few drops are enough, to adjust to each preparation
RECOMMENDED USES	Everyday pastry, creams, dairy preparations
SHELF LIFE	Up to 2 years, chilled (~4°C), away from light



REFERENCE 03 · SIGNATURE

Alcohol-free oleoresin AF20X

20X

Our signature extract. Twice as concentrated as the AF10X, it delivers remarkable aromatic intensity in a few drops — the strength equivalent of many whole pods.

ORIGIN	Madagascar
EXTRACTION METHOD	Distilled water + vacuum concentration
ALCOHOL	None
VANILLIN CONTENT	2.1 to 2.4%

APPEARANCE	Thick, dark brown liquid
AROMA PROFILE	Intense, warm, chocolatey, highly concentrated
RECOMMENDED USES	Fine pastry, chocolate work, high-intensity uses
SHELF LIFE	Up to 18 months, chilled (~4°C)

Available in 5 ml, 10 ml and 20 ml, and in professional formats on request.

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Let's talk about your project

Samples, full technical sheets and quotes tailored to your volumes: pastry, chocolate, hotels, ice cream, food industry.

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